

William Dong

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

B.S. Mechanical Engineering, Freshman

Expected May 2030

Great Valley High School

Senior · Malvern, PA · GPA 4.0 / 4.0

2022 – 2026

Relevant coursework: AP Physics C (Mechanics, E&M), AP Calculus BC, AP CSA

EXPERIENCE

MechE Intern, UGV Defense Company

Summer 2026

Raptor Defense Company

- Led SCORPION, an expendable payload vehicle, as lead and sole mechanical engineer, owning the full mechanical design from concept to working prototype.
- Designed the complete assembly in Onshape in 6 days, then manufactured and assembled it in 3.
- Delivered on spec: exceeded 50 mph (conservative estimate), used under 50% of the R&D budget, and passed the preliminary test matrix.
- Built a Portable Control Unit for the electronics team in SolidWorks.

Founder & CEO

2024 – Present

Formula Theory & Automotive Design (FTAD) · 501(c)(3) Nonprofit

- Founded an F1-inspired robotics competition nonprofit, securing \$55,000+ in funding through targeted sponsorships and grant acquisition.
- Conducted extensive market research and obtained international product validation, establishing FTAD's competition framework across multiple countries.
- Engineered competition vehicle designs in Onshape and Fusion 360, applying CFD simulation and topology optimization to maximize aerodynamic and structural performance.

Student Researcher

2026 – Present

Carnegie Mellon University · Robotics Institute · Biorobotics Lab

- Selected for the Biorobotics Lab within Carnegie Mellon's top-ranked Robotics Institute, a world leader in bio-inspired and snake robotics.
- Currently leading a novel locomotion project as a freshman, the only undergraduate in the lab to lead one: a robot that fires an anchor onto a structure and pulls itself toward it, developed from zero prior work.
- Also developing and testing experimental hardware for a bio-inspired snake robot.

Accelerator-Backed Builder

2026 – Present

Scotty Labs Foundry · Carnegie Mellon University

- Selected by application to the founding cohort; building ground UAS systems.

Design Lead & CAD Specialist

2024 – 2026

VEX Robotics · World-Qualified Competitive Team

- Led all mechanical design and CAD work on a team that qualified for the VEX World Championship in the 2024 season.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Co-Founder

2022 – 2024

NextGen Business & Law Forum · 501(c)(3) Nonprofit

- Organized entrepreneurship competitions for 500+ students across the United States.
- Oversaw event logistics, curriculum development, and partner outreach.

Competitive Boxer

2023 – Present

USA Boxing

- Two-time PA State Champion (2024 & 2025).
- Volunteer boxing coach, mentoring athletes ages 12–34 in technique, discipline, and sportsmanship.

Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA)

2025

Web Development · National Qualifier · 4th in Pennsylvania

- Learned web-dev logic in 4 months and built the competition project in a team of 3.

SKILLS

CAD & Design: Onshape, Fusion 360, SolidWorks, CFD Simulation, Topology Optimization

Programming: Python, Java, C++

Engineering: Kinematic Systems, Structural Analysis, Aerodynamic Simulation, Rapid Prototyping, UGV Systems

INTERESTS

Kinematics engineering, automotive engineering & racing technology, unmanned systems, defense technology, entrepreneurship, and combat sports.